British economist, E.F. Schumacher, which today exists in many different forms and flavors.[9] The experts defined it precisely this way – *appropriate technologies are those systems of technology which promote and maintain a sustainable culture*. The modern industrial culture of North America, Europe and other industrialised nations is hardly sustainable, and the technologies employed here exhibit dubious appropriateness.[10] It has been recognised that developing appropriate technology requires changes in the socio-political and cultural mind set.[11] We do not see these conditions available in the western developed world till recent times, as they have been the harbingers of technology diffusion to rest of the world. But in recent times, the attitude is changing. Since early 1970s experts have been debating everything from 'neutrality' of technology to the 'sustainable culture' and 'sustainable technologies' much of which is today known as the primers in 'environmentalism'. But at least the experts were able to sensitise the issue of sustainabilty and made the world think about in the coming decades in a more concerned way, and finally, we see the idea of 'sustainable development' being mooted out by the world in 1987.[12]

With societies coming to terms with the environmental implications of its economic and industrial practices, the role of technology is being increasingly scrutinised. The emergence of modern socio-technical systems marked a new phase in human creativity and scientific accomplishment, but has simultaneously resulted in the disruption of ecosystems from the local to the global level. A fundamental reorientation of both the principles of technology development and the institutional arrangements that govern the delivery of goods and services is required, in order to meet the needs of a rapidly expanding human population.

While some observers believe that technology can be harnessed and directed in ways that minimise degradation of ecosystems, it is often difficult to determine what constitutes an **'environmentally sound'** technology. While the explicit consideration of environmental objectives and constraints in product and process development can lead to ***'green'*** technology solutions, in reality, *the question of what is green depends on how environmental problems are defined.* As problem definitions change, solutions also change. The scholars and experts have disccussed, through